INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PACKAGING AND PACKING OF STEEL CREDENZA FURNITURE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the packaging, packing, material handling provision, and marking requirements of steel credenza furniture as covered by Federal Specification AA-C-1919 (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
NN-P-71	-	Pallets, Material Handling, Wood, Stringer Construction, 2-Way and 4-Way (Partial).
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640	-	Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.
PPP-F-320	-	Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock and Cut Shapes.
QQ-S-781	-	Strapping, Steel, Flat and Round.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials used in the packaging, packing, palletization, and marking of the contemporary steel office credenzas shall be as specified herein and in the applicable specifications.

3.1.1 Polyethylene film. The polyethylene film used herein shall conform to L-P-378, type I, grade A, finish 1. The minimum thickness shall be 1.5 mils unless otherwise specified herein.

3.1.2 Fiberboard. The fiberboard material used herein shall conform to PPP-F-320, type CF, class domestic, variety DW. The minimum grade shall be 200 unless otherwise specified herein.

3.1.3 Lumber. All lumber used in the construction of the base frame and the wood skid base herein shall conform to MIL-STD-731, class 2, group I, II, or III wood.

3.1.4 Steel strapping. The steel strapping used as specified herein shall conform with QQ-S-781, class 1, type I or IV regular duty, finish A. The size of the strapping shall be as specified herein.

3.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1 Levels A and B.

3.2.1.1 Each credenza shall be wiped clean prior to packaging and have all leg glides set at their lowest position. All drawers, doors, and internal parts such as partitions, follower blocks and shelves that can come loose in handling and transit shall be secured in place with tape, fiberboard forms, packing clips or other suitable means. Alternatively, internal parts that are removed shall be individually wrapped in non-abrasive material, packed in a fiberboard box and secured in a bottom drawer or shelf of the unit. Cellulose wadding strips or non-abrasive cushioning pads not less than .125 inch thick shall be used on the top and side edges of each drawer front and the exposed edges of the doors, when applicable, to prevent metal to metal contact when closed. When locks are provided, the drawers shall be closed, the unit locked, the keys placed in a kraft paper envelope, a fabric drawstring bag or a bag made of polyethylene film as specified in 3.1.1 - minimum 2 mils thick, and the bag secured in a recessed drawer handle.

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3.2.1.2 Each credenza shall be covered with a bag made of polyethylene film as specified in 3.1.1. Alternatively, the bag cover may be omitted when the top of the credenza is covered with a sheet of non-abrasive material and the inside face of the corner and center pads, as specified in 3.3.2.1.2 and 3.3.2.1.3, are coated with a non-abrasive and non-transferable coating such as Resist-O-Coat, Michalman or equal. The cover sheet, made of polyethylene film as specified in 3.1.1 or of cushioning material - minimum thickness .045 inch, shall extend down over the top edges of the credenza a minimum of 2 inches and be secured by taping the four sides in place.

3.2.2 Level C. Each credenza shall be prepared for packing to insure adequate protection against abrasion and damage during shipment.

3.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

3.3.1 Level A. Each credenza, packed as specified in 3.2.1, shall be packed in a tight-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, styles C or I; PPP-B-636, grade V3c, style FOL; or PPP-B-640, class 2. The interior packing shall conform to 3.3.2.1 or 3.3.2.2. The box shall be closed and strapped or reinforced in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

3.3.2 Level B. Each credenza packaged as specified in 3.2.1 shall be packed in accordance with 3.3.2.1 or 3.3.2.2 at the option of the supplier.

3.3.2.1 Method I. Each credenza, packaged as specified in 3.2.1, shall be packed in a tight-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, styles RSC or IC, type CF, class domestic, variety SW, minimum grade 275. The internal pack shall include the components specified in 3.3.2.1.1 through 3.3.2.1.5 inclusive. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636, except that nonmetallic strapping shall have a minimum breaking strength of 530 pounds.

3.3.2.1.1 Spring pad. A spring pad extending the full inside length and width of the box (-1/8" + 0") shall be positioned on top of each credenza (ref. figure A, B, and C). The spring pad shall be made from material as specified in 3.1.2. The fiberboard forming the spring pad shall have the corrugations parallel to the width of the box, be slit-scored and folded to provide a minimum clearance of 3/4 inch between the credenza top and the inside box flaps. The slit-scored folds shall be not less than 3-1/2 inches wide and shall parallel the length of the box.

3.3.2.1.2 Corner pads. "L" shaped corner pads extending from the top of the credenza to the bottom of the pedestal and resting on the suspension form, shall be used in all four corners of the pack (ref. figures A, B, C, and F). The corner pads shall be made from material as specified in 3.1.2. The fiberboard forming the pads shall be slit-scored and folded to provide a minimum inside face width of 2-1/2 inches and a clearance not less than 3/4 inch between the credenza and the inside walls of the box.

3.3.2.1.3 Center pad. Two center pads extending from the top of the credenza to the bottom of the pedestal and resting on the suspension form, shall be required in style A credenza packs only (ref. figure A). The center pads shall be made from material as specified in 3.1.2. The fiberboard forming the pad shall be slit-scored and folded to provide a minimum face width of 3 inches and a clearance not less than 3/4 inch between the credenza and the inside walls of the box. Each center pad shall be centered between the corner pads of the pack and secured in place on the side panels of the box. Alternatively, the center pads and corner pads as specified in 3.3.2.1.2, made from corrugated, laminated or molded fiberboard, shall be acceptable when the specified minimum dimensions are maintained.

3.3.2.1.4 Suspension form. A "U" shaped interlocking suspension form extending the full inside length and width of the box (-1/8" + 0") shall be used to suspend each credenza. The suspension form made from material as specified in 3.1.2, minimum grade 275 with vertical corrugations shall maintain a clearance of 3/4 inch (+ 1/8") between the bottom of the credenza legs and the wood base frame. The form shall consist of not less than two longitudinal support members - minimum width 5 inches with the open face down and die-cut cross support members - 3 inches wide with the open face up. The number of cross support members in the suspension forms shall be 5 for style A credenza, 4 for styles B and D, and 3 for style C. Each cross support member shall be centered over the corresponding wood cross member of the base frame, with the exception of style C credenza pack (ref. figures A, B, and C). Any unsupported area between the bottom of the credenza

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sections and the suspension form exceeding 10 inches in length along the longitudinal support members of the suspension form, shall be filled with a corrugated fiberboard filler pad. The filler pad shall be made of 1 or 2 piece sections at the supplier's option.

3.3.2.1.5 Base frame. A base frame extending the full inside length and width of the box (-1/4" + 0") shall be used in packing styles A, B, and D credenzas. The base frame shall be made from lumber as specified in 3.1.3. Unless otherwise specified herein, the size of the lumber shall be nominal 1 x 4 inch. The base frames shall consist of two length runners and five cross members with the two end members of 1 x 6 inch nominal lumber (ref. figures A and B). Two cross members shall be applied on 24 inch centers in from each end for base frames in style A credenza packs and on 16 inch centers for bases in styles B and D packs. The fifth cross member shall be applied at the center of each base frame. All cross members shall be clinch-nailed with not less than 2 nails per joint. Style C credenza pack shall not require a base frame.

3.3.2.2 Method II. Each credenza packaged as specified in 3.2.1 shall be packed as specified in 3.3.2.1, except that the base frame specified in 3.3.2.1.5, shall be omitted and replaced with a bottom pad. The bottom pad, made from material as specified in 3.1.2 minimum grade 275, shall extend the full inside length and width of the box (ref. figure D).

3.3.3 Level C. Each credenza, packaged as specified in 3.2.2, shall be individually packed in a box that will assure acceptance and safe delivery in compliance with National Motor Freight Classification or the Uniform Freight Classification.

3.4 Material Handling Provisions. Credenzas packed as specified in 3.3.1 or 3.3.2 shall be shipped on wood blocks or palletized in accordance with 3.4.1 or 3.4.2 respectively, when the requirements of the box specification do not provide access for material handling equipment, unless otherwise specified herein.

3.4.1 Wood blocks.

3.4.1.1 Styles A, B, and D credenzas. Styles A, B, or D credenzas packed as specified in 3.3.1 or 3.3.2.1 shall have four full dimensioned 2" x 6" x 8" long rough cut softwood blocks attached under each credenza pack. One block in each corner shall be nailed through the bottom of the box into the base frame with three 3 inch minimum length screw shank nails per block. An additional pair of wood blocks shall be attached under the center of style A credenza pack (ref. figures A and B).

3.4.1.2 Style C credenza. Style C credenza packs shall not require wood blocks.

3.4.2 Palletization.

3.4.2.1 Style C credenza. When specified (see 6.2), style C credenzas, packed as specified in 3.3.1, 3.3.2.1, or 3.3.2.2 shall be palletized in their upright position in two tiers of two each on a pallet conforming to NN-P-71, type I, class 1, except that the pallet shall be constructed with three stringers as shown in figure 1 of NN-P-71; chamfering of the deckboards is not required; there shall be only five top deckboards and three bottom deckboards equally spaced along the length of the stringers; and the width and length of the pallet shall be equal to the respective outside length and width of the load. The packed credenzas shall be strapped to the pallet with three straps conforming to QQ-S-781, class 1, type I or IV, size 1/2 x 0.020 inch or 5/8 x 0.015 inch. Each strap shall be applied around the top, front and back of the load of packed credenzas and the bottom side of the top deckboards of the pallet. The straps shall be applied equidistantly along the length of the packed credenzas except the middle strap shall be applied on one side of and directly adjacent to the middle stringer. Edge protectors shall be used where the strapping contacts the top edges of the top shipping containers. Each strap shall be sufficiently tensioned to prevent the load from shifting off its position on the pallet.

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3.4.2.2 Credenza styles A, B, and D - option I. Styles A, B, and D credenzas, packed as specified in 3.3.1, 3.3.2.1, or 3.3.2.2 shall be furnished on a wood skid base made from lumber as specified in 3.1.3. The length and width of the skid base shall be equal to the respective outside length and width of the load and shall consist of four 1 x 4 inch nominal lumber - two top and two bottom length deckboards and three 2 x 4 inch cross width stringers. Each packed credenza shall be secured to the skid base with not less than two steel straps conforming to material as specified in 3.1.4, minimum 1/2" x .020" or 5/8" x .015". Each strap, placed 6 (+ 1) inches in from each end of the container, shall be applied around the top, front and back of the credenza and under the bottom side of the top deckboards of the base skid. Edge protectors shall be used under the straps on the top edges of the container and the straps tensioned to prevent the packed credenza from shifting on the skid base (ref. figure D).

3.4.2.3 Credenza styles A, B, and D - option II. Two credenzas, styles A, B, and D, packed as specified in 3.3.1, 3.3.2.1, or 3.3.2.2 shall be palletized front side to front side in their upright position on a pallet conforming to NN-P-71, type I, class 1; except that the pallet shall be constructed with three stringers as shown in figure 1 of NN-P-71; chamfering of the deckboards is not required; there shall only be five top deckboards and three bottom deckboards equally spaced along the length of the stringers; and the width and length of the pallet shall be equal to the respective outside length and width of the load of packed credenzas. The packed credenza shall be strapped to the pallet with three straps conforming to QQ-S-781, class 1, type I or IV, size 1/2 x 0.020 inch or 5/8 x 0.015 inch. Each strap shall be applied around the top, front and back of the load of packed credenzas and the bottom side of the top deckboards of the pallet. The straps shall be applied equidistantly along the length of the packed credenzas except the middle strap shall be applied on one side of and directly adjacent to the middle stringer. Edge protectors shall be used where the strapping contacts the top edges of the shipping containers. Each strap shall be sufficiently tensioned to prevent the packed credenzas from shifting off their positions on the pallet.

3.5 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 3.5.1 or 3.5.2, as specified (see 6.2).

3.5.1 Civil agencies. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

3.5.2 Military activities. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

3.5.3 Special marking. In addition to the markings required by 3.5.1 or 3.5.2, each shipping container shall be marked as follows (ref. figure E):

(a) On the side panel:

↑ UP ↑
FURNITURE
FRAGILE, HANDLE WITH CARE

(b) In an upper corner of both end panels, a standard up arrow.

(c) On the top panel:

TOP
THIS SIDE UP

(d) To facilitate color identification, the front and one end panel of each shipping container shall have an area approximately 3 x 8 inches painted to match the color of the unit packed. Alternatively, adhesive-backed color panels of the size specified above shall be applied to the container.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that the packaging and packing materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified; or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of section 3. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers offered for acceptance at one time. The inspection level shall be S-4, with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, wrong location.
Materials	Packing materials not as specified; missing, damaged, or non-serviceable.
Workmanship	Straps not properly tensioned. Containers inadequately closed, poor application of internal packing parts, moveable or loose parts not secured properly.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

This section is not applicable to this specification.

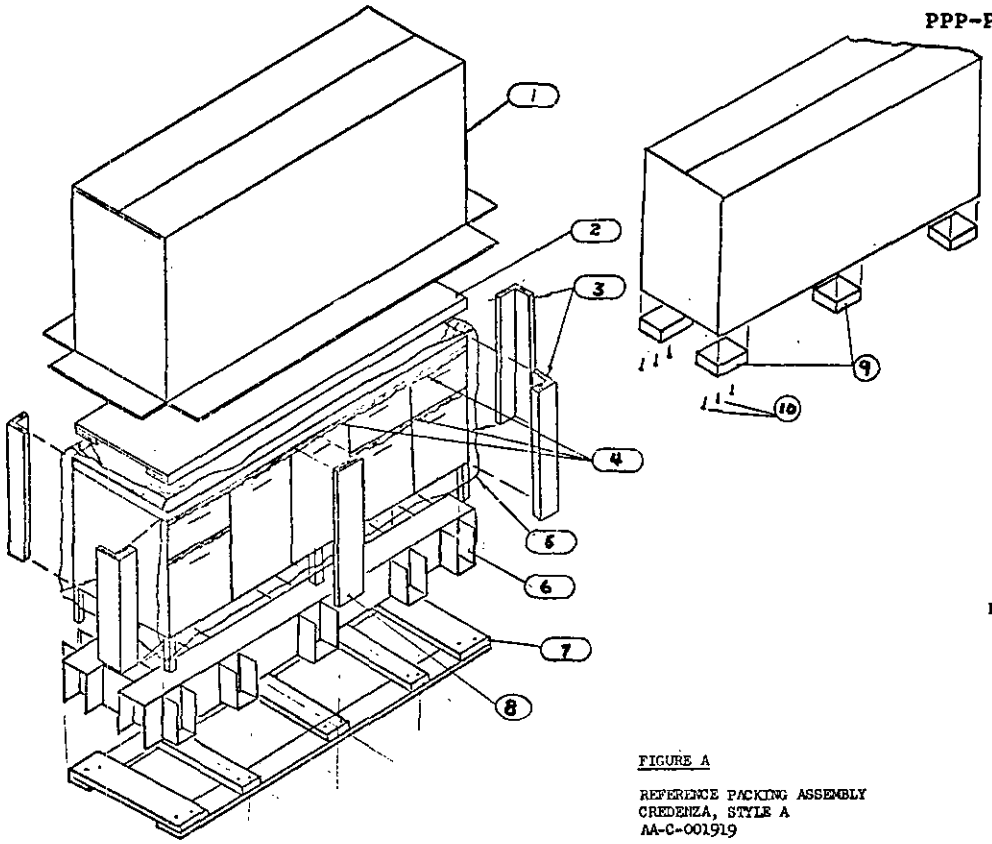
6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The requirements of this specification are intended to be used for the packaging, packing, and marking of steel credenza furniture. Provisions for material handling equipment access and palletization options also form a part of the requirements.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Packaging level required (see 3.2).
(c) Packing level required (see 3.3).
(d) Palletization (see 3.4.2).
(e) Type of marking required (see 3.5).

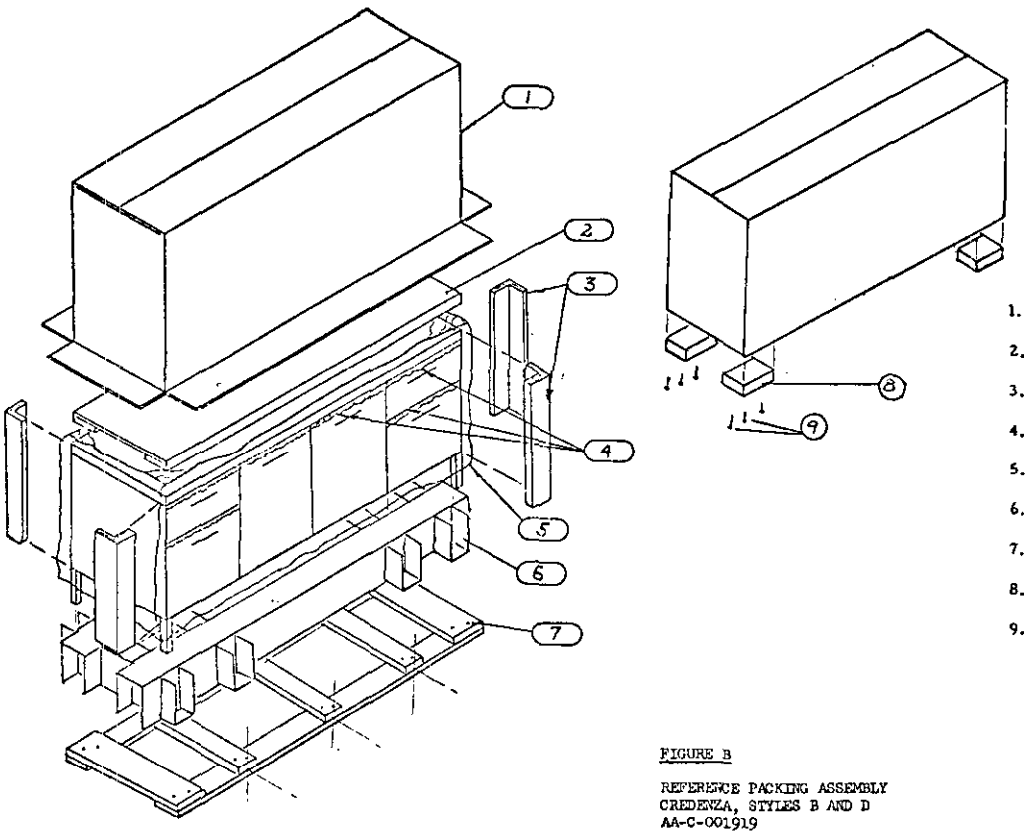
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1. Box
2. Spring Pad
3. Corner Pads (4 req'd)
4. Cushioning Material
5. Bag Cover
6. Suspension Form
7. Wood Base Frame
8. Center Pads (2 req'd)
9. Wood Blocks (6 req'd)
10. Nails

FIGURE A

REFERENCE PACKING ASSEMBLY
CREDENZA, STYLE A
AA-C-001919

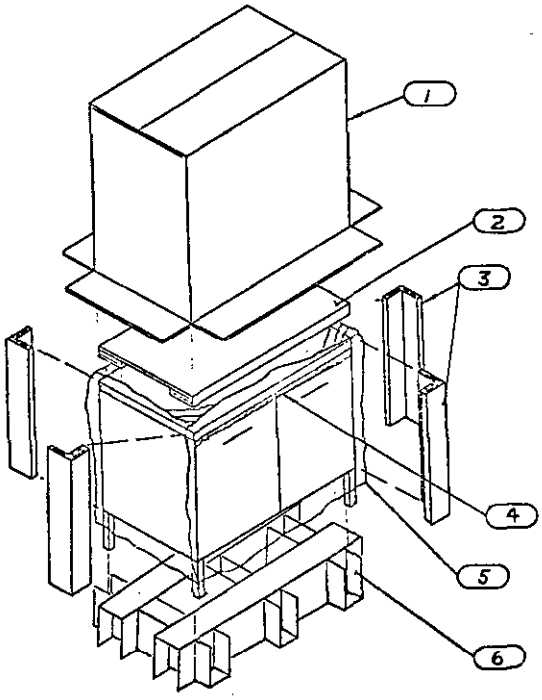


1. Box
2. Spring Pad
3. Corner Pads (4 req'd)
4. Cushioning Material
5. Bag Cover
6. Suspension Form
7. Wood Base Frame
8. Wood Blocks (4 req'd)
9. Nails

FIGURE B

REFERENCE PACKING ASSEMBLY
CREDENZA, STYLES B AND D
AA-C-001919

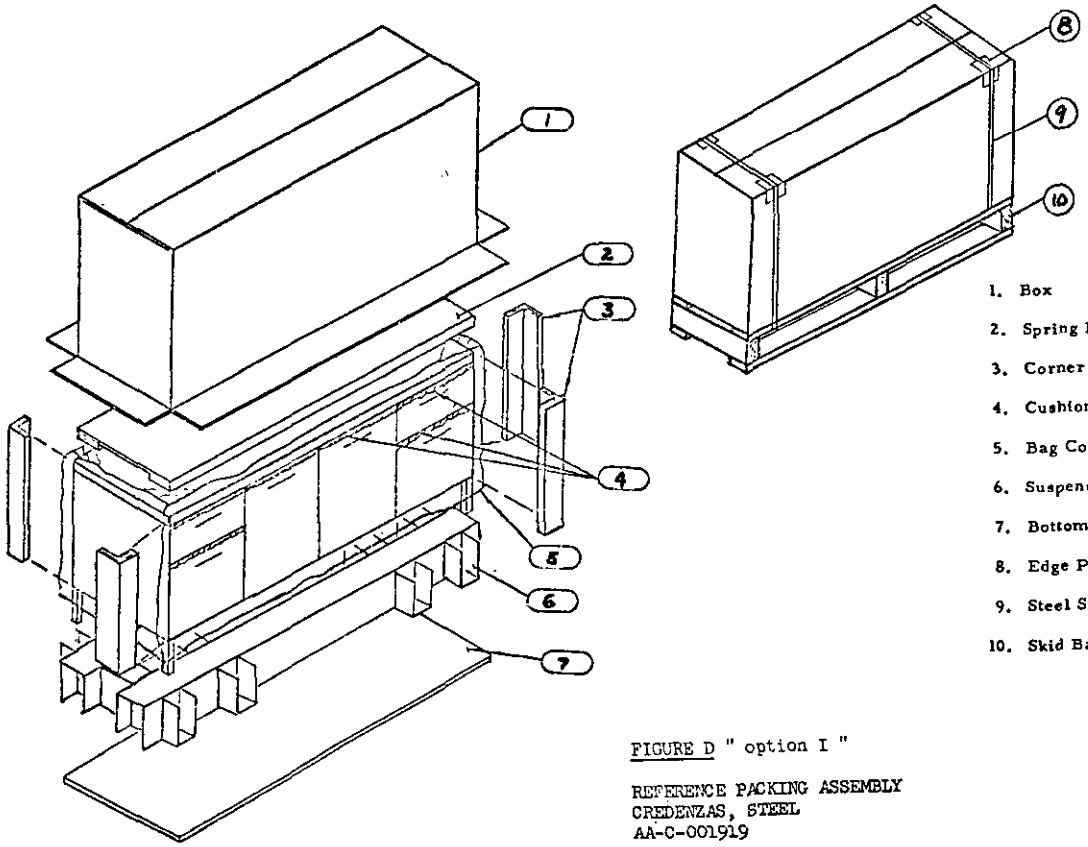
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1. Box
2. Spring Pad
3. Corner Pads (4 req'd)
4. Cushioning Material
5. Bag Cover
6. Suspension Form

FIGURE C

REFERENCE PACKING ASSEMBLY
CREDENZA, STYLE C
AA-C-001919



1. Box
2. Spring Pad
3. Corner Pads (4 req'd)
4. Cushioning Material
5. Bag Cover
6. Suspension Form
7. Bottom Pad
8. Edge Protector
9. Steel Strapping
10. Skid Base

FIGURE D " option I "

REFERENCE PACKING ASSEMBLY
CREDENZAS, STEEL
AA-C-001919

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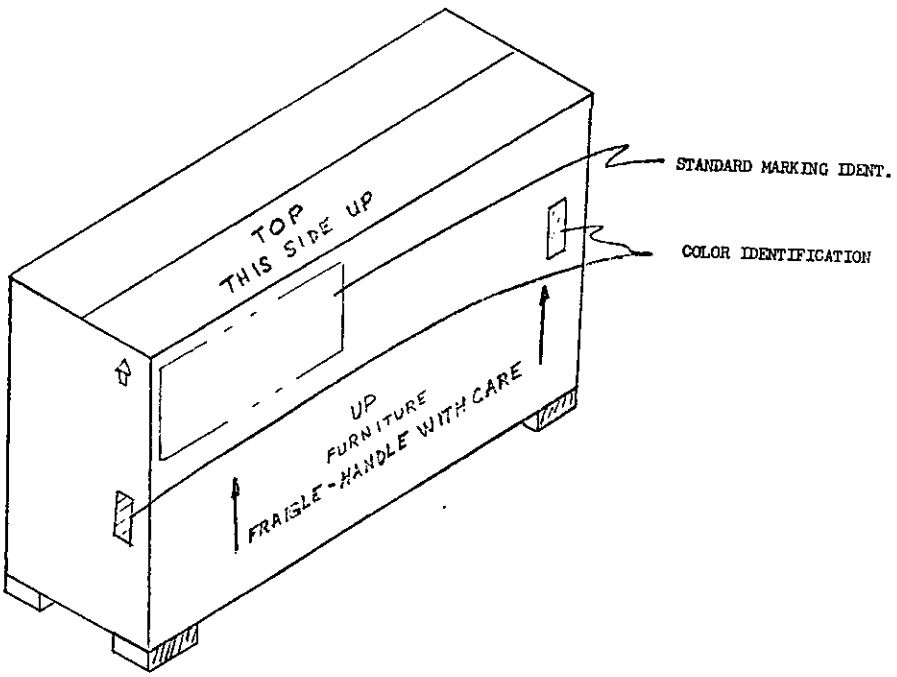


FIGURE E

Special Marking

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